

Natural Language Processing - Quiz 2

25 Marks , Time: 30 minutes

Name: _____

Roll no.: _____

Date: 17.02.2026

Instructions: Write all answers on the back-side of the page. Best of luck!

1 MCQ 10X1.5=15, for wrong choice, penalty is 0.5

Q1: Suppose you have a term-document matrix with N documents. A term t appears in exactly 1% of the documents. Which of the following is closest to its inverse document frequency $\text{idf}(t) = \log_{10}(\frac{N}{\text{df}_t})$?

- (a) 0
- (b) 1
- (c) 2
- (d) Can't be computed based on given information

Q2: You compute cosine similarity between three word vectors in a 3-dimensional space:

$$v_X = (3, 0, 4)$$

$$v_Y = (6, 0, 8)$$

$$v_Z = (0, 5, 0)$$

Which statement is correct?

- (a) $\cos(X, Y) = 1$ and $\cos(X, Z) = 0$
- (b) $\cos(X, Y) = 0.5$ and $\cos(X, Z) = 0$
- (c) $\cos(X, Y) = 1$ and $\cos(Y, Z) = 0.5$
- (d) All pairwise cosine similarities are strictly between 0 and 1

Q3: Skip-gram with negative sampling (SGNS) trains a classifier that, for each target-context pair (t, c) , predicts whether the pair is sampled from real text or from a noise distribution. Which of the following best describes what becomes the word embedding?

- (a) The bias term of the logistic regression classifier
- (b) The gradient of the loss for each training example
- (c) The probability assigned to real pairs after training
- (d) The learned weight vectors associated with targets and/or contexts

Q4: In word2vec's SGNS, increasing the number of negative samples per positive example

(k) typically has which effect, holding everything else fixed?

- (a) It reduces training time but harms embedding quality
- (b) It increases training time but can improve the quality of the learned space
- (c) It has no effect as long as $k \geq 1$
- (d) It improves the quality with same amount of training time

Q5: Consider two words, "doctor" and "nurse", in a static embedding space that was trained on a corpus with strong gender stereotypes. Their nearest neighbors show that "doctor" is close to "he" and "nurse" is close to "she". Which statement is most accurate?

- (a) This proves that the model has eliminated gender bias by separating occupations
- (b) The embeddings encode historical gender stereotypes present in the training data
- (c) The bias arises purely from random initialization
- (d) Cosine similarity is invariant to such biases

Q6: In a simple RNN with recurrence $h_t = g(Uh_{t-1} + Wx_t)$, which statement about inference is correct?

- (a) Computing h_t requires h_{t-1} , so inference proceeds incrementally from $t=1$ to $t=n$.
- (b) All hidden states for a sequence can be computed in parallel because weights are shared.
- (c) Inference starts from the last token and proceeds backward.
- (d) The hidden state at time t is independent of the previous inputs once W is known.

Q7: For an RNN language model, which of the following best distinguishes it from an n -gram language model?

- (a) It always uses a fixed context window

of size 3.

- (b) It conditions on a one-hot vector of the next word rather than the previous words.
- (c) It has no fixed context size; h_{t-1} can, in principle, summarize the entire history.
- (d) It cannot be trained with cross-entropy loss.

Q8: In training an RNN language model, teacher forcing refers to:

- (a) Forcing the model to predict the next word without using any previous words.
- (b) Always feeding the model its own predicted next word as the next input.
- (c) Training only on sequences where the model already achieves low loss.
- (d) Always giving the model the gold previous word as input when predicting the next word.

Q9: What main problem do LSTMs address compared to simple RNNs?

- (a) The inability of RNNs to process variable-length sequences.
- (b) The high memory cost of storing all hidden states during backpropagation.
- (c) The vanishing (and exploding) gradient problem when modeling long-distance dependencies.
- (d) The fact that RNNs cannot be stacked or used bidirectionally.

Q10: Interpolation differs from backoff because interpolation:

- (a) Uses only lower-order models
- (b) Discards higher-order probabilities
- (c) Combines multiple N-gram models simultaneously
- (d) Assigns zero probability to unseen events

2 Fill in the Blanks

(Q11) In tf-idf weighting, the inverse document frequency term is based on the ratio N/df_t , where N is the total number of documents and df_t is the number of documents containing term t ; this gives higher weight to terms that appear in _____ documents.
[1]

(Q12) In Osgood et al. (1957), connotation is

modeled as a point in a 3-dimensional affective space whose axes are _____, _____, and _____. [1]

(Q13) The **ReLU** activation function is defined as $y = \max(z, 0)$; its derivative with respect to z is 0 for $z < 0$ and _____ for $z \geq 0$.
[1]

3 Numerical

(a) Consider a simple RNN with scalar inputs, hidden states, and outputs. The recurrence is

$$h_t = \tanh(Uh_{t-1} + Wx_t), \quad \hat{y}_t = \text{softmax}(Vh_t).$$

Assume:

- Vocabulary size $|V| = 3$, so $\hat{y}_t$ is a 3-dimensional probability vector.
- At time $t = 1$: input one-hot $x_1 = (1, 0, 0)^\top$, and you may treat the scalar pre-activation as $Wx_1 = 0.5$.
- Parameters: $U = 0.4$, $W = 0.5$, $V = [1.0, -0.5, 0.0]$.
- Initial hidden state: $h_0 = 0$.

(a) Compute h_1 .

(b) Compute the unnormalized logits $z = Vh_1$.

(c) Compute the softmax probabilities $\hat{y}_1$.

[2+2+3=7 Marks]

(a) $h_1 =$

(b) $z =$

(c) $\hat{y}_1 =$

Answer **(a) Hidden state h_1 .**

The pre-activation for the hidden state is

$$a_1 = Uh_0 + Wx_1 = 0.4 \cdot 0 + 0.5 = 0.5.$$

Hence

$$h_1 = \tanh(0.5).$$

Numerically, $\tanh(0.5) \approx 0.4621$, so

$$h_1 \approx 0.4621.$$

(b) Logits z .

The logits are

$$z = Vh_1 = \begin{bmatrix} 1.0 \\ -0.5 \\ 0.0 \end{bmatrix} h_1 = \begin{bmatrix} 1.0h_1 \\ -0.5h_1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \approx \begin{bmatrix} 0.4621 \\ -0.2310 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

(c) Softmax probabilities $\hat{y}_1$.

We compute

$$\hat{y}_{1,i} = \frac{\exp(z_i)}{\sum_{j=1}^3 \exp(z_j)}.$$

Approximate exponentials:

$$\exp(0.4621) \approx 1.587, \quad \exp(-0.2310) \approx 0.794, \quad \exp(0) = 1.$$

Denominator:

$$Z = 1.587 + 0.794 + 1 = 3.381.$$

Thus

$$\hat{y}_{1,1} = \frac{1.587}{3.381} \approx 0.469, \quad \hat{y}_{1,2} = \frac{0.794}{3.381} \approx 0.235, \quad \hat{y}_{1,3} = \frac{1}{3.381} \approx 0.296.$$

So

$$\hat{y}_1 \approx [0.469, 0.235, 0.296].$$

Answers

Q1: c

Q9: c

Q2: a

Q10: c

Q3: d

Q11: fewer

Q4: b

Q12: valence, arousal,
dominance [or-
der does not
matter]

Q5: b

Q6: a

Q7: c

Q13: 1

Q8: d